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Office of Research & Development

VA Animal Research Guidance Documents

Guidance Document #	Title	Distribution Date
AR2023-003	How-To Guide for Researchers: VA IACUC Functions in VAIRRS How-To Guide for IACUC Administrators: VA IACUC Functions in VAIRRS How-To Guide for IACUC Reviewers: VA IACUC Functions in VAIRRS	November 29, 2023
AR2023-002	Annotations and Guidance for Implementation of VHA Directive 1200.07 VA Research with Animals (May 23, 2023)	June 23, 2023 (original) October 6, 2023 (typos corrected) November 11, 2023 (numbering of references corrected)
AR2023-001	Rescission of FAQs on COVID-19 and VA Animal Care and Use Programs	June 23, 2023
AR2022-002	Preliminary Pre-Decisional Notifications about Potentially Reportable Matters	July 19, 2022
AR2022-001	Office of Research Development and Office of Information Security–Research Support Division Joint Guidance on Considerations for The Protection of Sensitive Data from VA Research with Animals	March 10, 2022
AR2020-001	Signatures Required for VA Protocols for Research with Animals	November 23, 2020 (original) May 24, 2022 (updated) April 7, 2023 (revision 2) May 15, 2023 (revision 3)
AR2019-001	USDA Definition of Category E (Summary and Clarification by the Office of the CVMQ)	October 11, 2019
AR2018-001	Adoption of Research Animals Covered by the USDA Animal Welfare Act Regulations Supporting Documents: VA Agreement with Homes for Animal Heroes for Arranging Suitable Adoptions (August 14, 2018) AVMA Policy on Adoption of Research Animals (2019)	July 2, 2018

	ACLAM Position Statement on Adoption of Research Animals (October 2017)	
AR2017-001	Canine, Feline and Non-Human Primate Research Protocols (revised guidance, expanded to incorporate review and approval by the Secretary and to address research with felines and non-human primates in addition to canines)	July 16, 2020 (revision 5)
AR2016-001	ORD-ORO Joint Guidance on Semi-annual Reviews of the ACUP (guidance)	September 23, 2016
AR2015-005	Drafting an MOU (template tool)	August 13, 2015 (original), March 28, 2018 (updated), May 29, 2018 (typos corrected); January 03, 2020 (revised)
AR2015-004	Criteria for NSM and NAM (guidance) Decision Flowcharts	August 13, 2015 (written guidance) December 8, 2016 (flowcharts)
AR2015-003	Annual Continuing Review of Protocols (guidance)	August 11, 2015
AR2015-002	Mechanisms for Modifying Approved Protocols (flowchart)	March 12, 2015
AR2015-001	Departures Decision Tree (flowchart)	March 12, 2015
AR2014-001	What to Copy to the CVMO (guidance)	June 2, 2014

Animal care staff.

Animal care staff members should receive training appropriate for their responsibilities, and consistent with the training commitments in both the AAALAC Program Description and PHS Assurance. Some stations utilize the web coursework in item number 2 as part of the overall training program, but this is not a requirement in VA policy.

Guidance on Animal Research FOIA Requests

On January 30, 2013, VHA issued [updated guidance to FOIA Officers](#) (1.6 MB, PDF) on FOIA requests related to animal research. Please notify the CVMO's office immediately if your station receives such a request.

Animal Facility (Veterinary Medical Unit) renovation and construction resources

The VA Research and Development Design Guide (June 1, 2022) is available at <https://www.cfm.va.gov/til/dGuide/dgResearch.pdf> . Chapter 2.6 specifically addresses the Veterinary Medical Unit.

The VHA Space Planning Criteria (PG-18-9) Chapter 278 for Research and Development (June 1, 2022) is available at <https://www.cfm.va.gov/til/space/spChapter278.pdf> .

Further guidance is available from the CVMO.

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Questions about the R&D website? [Email the Web Team](#)

Any health information on this website is strictly for informational purposes and is not intended as medical advice. It should not be used to diagnose or treat any condition.

Veteran programs and services

Homeless Veterans
Women Veterans
Minority Veterans
LGBTQ+ Veterans
PTSD
Mental health
Adaptive sports and special events
VA outreach events
National Resource Directory

More VA resources

VA forms
VA health care access and quality
Accredited claims representatives
VA mobile apps
State Veterans Affairs offices
Doing business with VA
Careers at VA
VA outreach materials
Your VA welcome kit

Get VA updates

VA news
Press releases
Email updates
Facebook
Instagram
Twitter
Flickr
YouTube
All VA social media

In crisis? Get help now

Veterans Crisis Line

Get answers

Resources and support
Contact us

Call us

800-698-2411
TTY: 711

Visit a medical center or regional office

Find a VA location

Language assistance

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